DIPLOMACY AS A TECHNIQUE OF FOREIGN POLICY

As already noted, diplomacy entirely involves direct government-to-government interactions so that a particular state can persuade governments in their countries to act in the manner in which it wants them to do. Therefore, diplomacy is considered as the central technique of foreign policy implementations and effectively the only direct technique where the central feature is communication. Most of the rules of protocol, diplomatic immunities and non-interference have been established and codified to facilitate communication and reduce misunderstanding and distortion in inter-state communication.

From the perspective of world politics “diplomacy refers to a process of communication that is central to the working of the international system”. If world politics is identified as being the interplay between conflict and cooperation, then, war and diplomacy can be said to represent the two defining institutions (see Figure 5.1). If conflict and cooperation are placed at the two ends

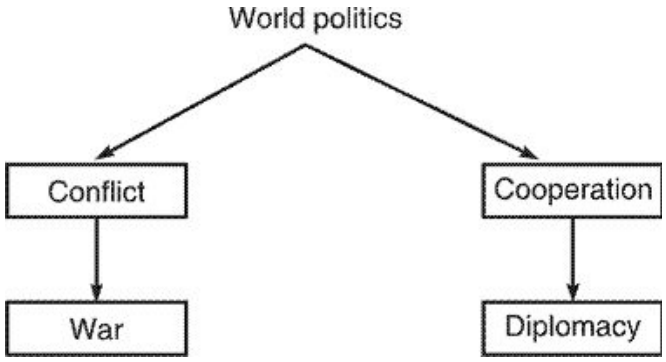


Figure 5.1 Illustration of world politics.

[**Source:** Adapted from Brian White][17]

of a spectrum, diplomacy will feature at the cooperation and war on the conflict end. This is because, the main focus of diplomacy is the resolution of conflict by negotiation and dialogue and an attempt to create some sort of order within the world politics to prevent a conflict spilling over into war.[24]

“Diplomacy offers one instrument that international actors might use to implement their foreign policy either as its own right or as a means